Ideation Phase
Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	24 July 2026
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Project Name	Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

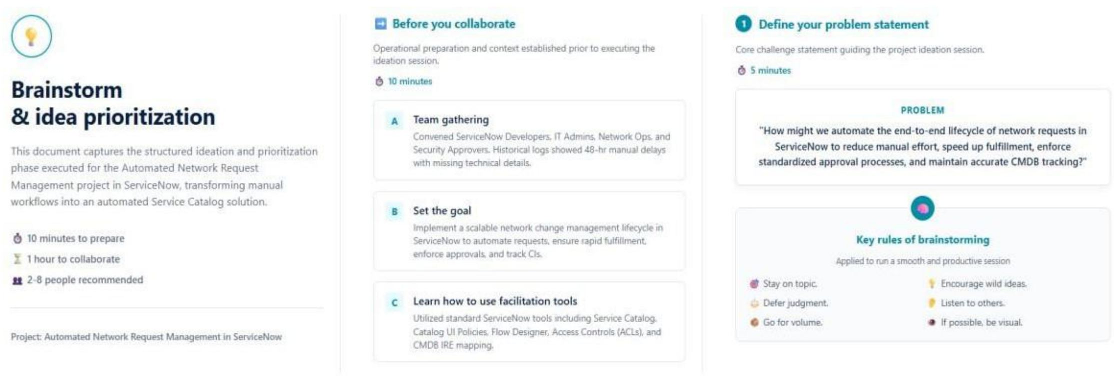
Team Gathering & Collaboration

Our team aligned through a hybrid model of virtual synchronization workshops and co-located design sessions, leveraging collaborative digital workspaces to evaluate corporate IT infrastructure inefficiencies. The core of our investigative effort targeted operational workflows managed by enterprise service teams, specifically analyzing how network provisioning deployments, physical asset modifications, and workspace relocation requests are handled.

Defined Problem Statement

The discovery phase revealed that the legacy framework for managing corporate network provisioning depends heavily on fragmented, decentralized communication pathways—such as unmonitored shared mailboxes, manual spreadsheet tracking, and informal verbal requests. This structural deficiency introduces severe operational vulnerabilities:

- **Deficient Metadata Collection:** Requesters frequently omit business-critical physical infrastructure variables—such as device context requirements, terminal extension layouts, or exact structural building coordinates—triggering prolonged backend clarification cycles.
- **Absence of Process Transparency:** Requests routinely stall indefinitely within administrative queues due to the lack of an automated workflow engine or dynamic managerial authorization routing.
- **Systemic Data Integrity Decay:** Manual transcription and data-entry practices introduce frequent clerical errors, resulting in mismatched hardware serial configurations, broken asset lifecycle dependencies, and flawed network configuration records.



Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Executive Overview

During the structured ideation session, the cross-functional project team (ServiceNow Developers, IT Administrators, Network Engineers, and Security Approvers) generated 12 targeted technical solutions on the ServiceNow platform. These ideas were evaluated, refined, and grouped into four distinct operational clusters to establish the core architecture for the **Automated Network Request Management** project.

Technical Idea Clusters & Implementation Details

Cluster 1: Catalog Form & User Experience (UX)

- **[Idea A1] Dynamic Form Behavior:** Implemented Catalog UI Policies on the Service Portal to dynamically show or hide fields (ip_address_range, access_level, target_device) based on the selected request_type to simplify the end-user submission process.
- **[Idea A2] Input Validation:** Applied mandatory field constraints and regular expression
- **[Idea A3] Contextual Guidance:** Configured dynamic info messages within the catalog

form to inform users of specific Security Group approval requirements whenever administrative access is requested.

Cluster 2: Approvals & Workflow Governance

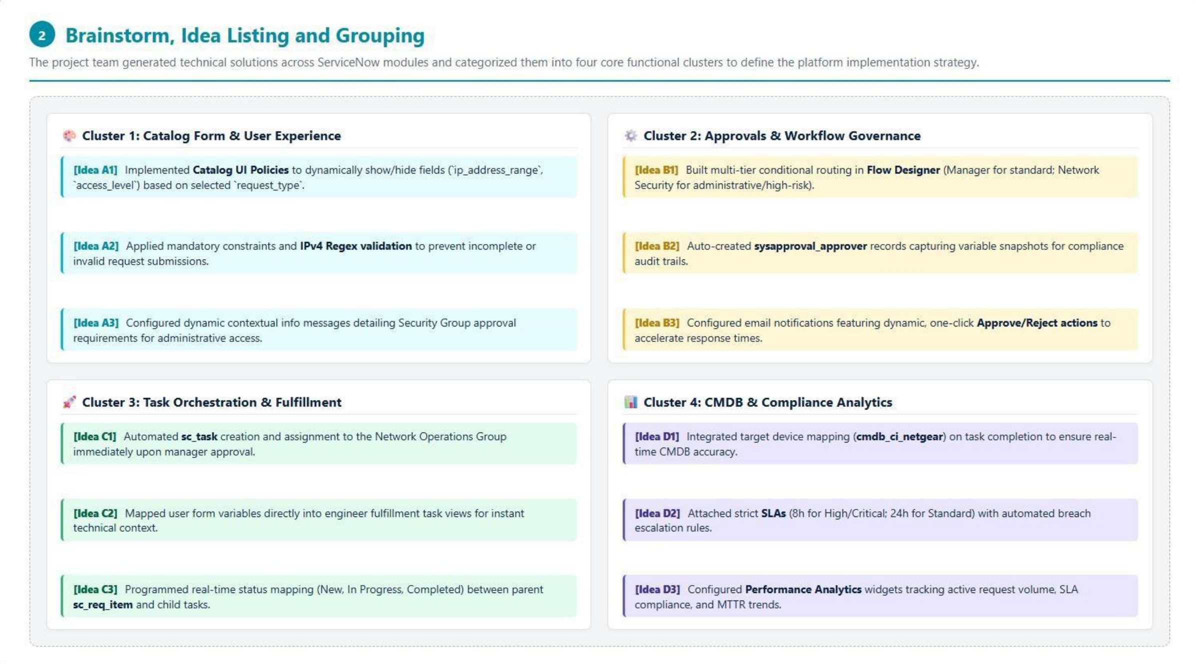
- **[Idea B1] Multi-Tier Conditional Routing:** Designed a dynamic approval workflow in Flow Designer that routes standard requests to line managers while automatically escalating administrative and high-priority requests to the Network Security Approvers group.
- **[Idea B2] Compliance Audit Logging:** Configured automated generation of sysapproval_approver records that capture full form variable snapshots at the time of approval, establishing an audit-ready compliance trail.
- **[Idea B3] Email Approval Integration:** Enabled system notifications with dynamic, one-click **Approve** and **Reject** buttons, allowing managers to process approvals directly from their
email inboxes.

Cluster 3: Task Orchestration & Fulfillment

- **[Idea C1] Automated Task Generation:** Programmed Flow Designer to automatically generate and assign Catalog Tasks (sc_task) to the Network Operations Group immediately upon
receiving necessary approvals.
- **[Idea C2] Context-Rich Engineer Views:** Mapped user form variables directly into the fulfillment task view, equipping network engineers with immediate technical details without requiring back-and-forth communication.
- **[Idea C3] Real-Time State Synchronization:** Established automated state mapping between parent sc_req_item and child sc_task records to ensure real-time visibility across all stages (*New, In Progress, Completed, Closed Rejected*).

Cluster 4: CMDB & Compliance Analytics

- **[Idea D1] Target Device CMDB Mapping:** Integrated request fulfillment with the Configuration Management Database (CMDB) to automatically associate and update target devices (cmdb_ci_netgear) upon task completion.
- **[Idea D2] Service Level Agreements (SLAs):** Attached strict resolution SLAs to requests—targeting 8 hours for High/Critical requests and 24 hours for Standard requests—with automated escalation triggers upon risk of breach.
- **[Idea D3] Operational Dashboards:** Configured Performance Analytics and reporting widgets on executive dashboards to track active request volume, SLA compliance rates, and mean
time to resolution (MTTR) trends.



Step-3: Idea Prioritization Executive Overview

To establish a clear execution path for the **Automated Network Request Management** project in ServiceNow, the project team plotted all brainstormed technical solutions onto an **Importance vs. Feasibility Grid**. This visual prioritization process allowed the team to evaluate each capability based on its operational value against implementation complexity, cost, and effort.

Grid Axis Definitions & Evaluation Criteria

1. Importance (Y-Axis)

- **Definition:** Evaluates the overall business impact, compliance value, and reduction in fulfillment turnaround time if implemented without constraints.
- **Key Criteria:** Reduction in manual ticket delays, audit readiness, SLA enforcement, and error reduction.

2. Feasibility (X-Axis)

- **Definition:** Evaluates the technical effort, configuration complexity, and platform maintenance required for execution.
- **Key Criteria:** Native out-of-the-box (OOTB) capability vs. custom scripting, integration effort, testing overhead, and deployment risks.

Prioritization Grid Mapping & Placement

High Importance / High Feasibility (Quick Wins — Top Right)

These items deliver maximum operational efficiency with low configuration effort using native, lowcode ServiceNow functionality:

- **[Idea A1 & A2] Dynamic Form UI Policies & IPv4 Regex Validation:** Captures structured, validated user input directly on the Service Portal, eliminating incomplete submissions.
- **[Idea B1 & C1] Flow Designer Approvals & Automated Task Creation:** Executes dynamic manager/security approval logic and automatically spawns sc_task records for Network Operations upon approval.
- **[Idea D2] Resolution SLAs:** Applies automated 8-hour and 24-hour SLA targets with breach escalation rules.

High Importance / Moderate Feasibility (Strategic Initiatives — Center Upper)

These capabilities provide major long-term compliance and asset visibility, requiring structured data modeling:

- **[Idea D1] Target Device CMDB Mapping:** Links fulfillment tasks directly to configuration items (cmdb_ci_netgear) upon task resolution to maintain real-time CMDB data accuracy.
- **[Idea C2] Contextual Task Variable Views:** Exposes form variables directly on engineer fulfillment task screens for immediate technical context.

High Importance / Low Feasibility (High Complexity — Left Upper)

- **IntegrationHub Auto-Provisioning Spokes:** Automated REST/SSH background API calls to network switches and firewalls to execute zero-touch network changes.

Low Importance / Low Feasibility (Future Scope — Bottom Left)

- **[Idea D3] Performance Analytics Executive Dashboards:** Advanced, long-term metric reporting widgets for historical trend analysis.